DEBIAN - PRINTABLE TASK CHECKLIST

223 separate tasks | Tick a square for each completed inspection, fix or verification

Round/date: _____ Team: _____

Image: _____ Starting score: _____ Final: _____

Write N/A beside items that do not apply. See full platform guide before changes.

01. Identify Debian and establish recovery

- ☐ **D001** Read the actual README and any special competition constraints N/A
- ☐ **D002** Check Debian version and codename in /etc/os-release N/A
- ☐ **D003** Record whether the system uses GNOME, another desktop, or no GUI N/A
- ☐ **D004** Confirm current user and UID/GID with id N/A
- ☐ **D005** Check whether sudo is installed and authorized N/A
- ☐ **D006** Confirm a working root or authorized sudo recovery path N/A
- ☐ **D007** Record system hostname and network interface addresses N/A
- ☐ **D008** Record default route and DNS behavior N/A
- ☐ **D009** Record starting scoring-report value and timestamp N/A
- ☐ **D010** List required human accounts and authorized administrators N/A
- ☐ **D011** List required services, server roles, shares and listening ports N/A
- ☐ **D012** Identify prohibited software and files listed by the README N/A
- ☐ **D013** Take an approved VM snapshot if allowed N/A
- ☐ **D014** Create private change notes and record original values N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

02. Forensic evidence before remediation

- ☐ **D015** Open every forensic question and note the exact answer format N/A
- ☐ **D016** Locate requested files before deleting or updating anything N/A
- ☐ **D017** Inspect file metadata with stat where relevant N/A
- ☐ **D018** Identify actual file type with file when relevant N/A
- ☐ **D019** Calculate requested SHA-256 hash with sha256sum N/A
- ☐ **D020** Investigate suspicious service, task or process paths N/A

- [ ] **D021** Inspect current system journal without clearing it N/A
- [ ] **D022** Review relevant ssh, sudo and cron journal entries N/A
- [ ] **D023** Check login history when the question involves user activity N/A
- [ ] **D024** Decode requested encoded text only as data N/A
- [ ] **D025** Save every forensic answer in the original supplied file N/A
- [ ] **D026** Confirm evidence was preserved and unanswered questions are noted N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

03. Human accounts, root, and administrator groups

- [ ] **D027** Inventory /etc/passwd entries and likely human users N/A
- [ ] **D028** Compare local human accounts with the README N/A
- [ ] **D029** Identify any additional UID 0 account N/A
- [ ] **D030** Inspect root account password-lock status N/A
- [ ] **D031** Confirm the system’s root-versus-sudo administration design N/A
- [ ] **D032** Inspect sudo group members N/A
- [ ] **D033** Inspect adm group members N/A
- [ ] **D034** Inspect disk, shadow, docker, lxd and libvirt group members if present N/A
- [ ] **D035** Inspect sudoers and sudoers.d authorization rules N/A
- [ ] **D036** Check for NOPASSWD or unsafe wildcard sudo grants N/A
- [ ] **D037** Validate sudo policy syntax with visudo -c N/A
- [ ] **D038** Review each normal user’s login shell N/A
- [ ] **D039** Identify unexpected human accounts with a service-like UID N/A
- [ ] **D040** Check missing README-authorized users N/A
- [ ] **D041** Lock only a confirmed unauthorized login after evidence is saved N/A
- [ ] **D042** Remove only confirmed unauthorized privileged membership N/A
- [ ] **D043** Verify authorized sudo/root administration still works N/A
- [ ] **D044** Open a second authorized login after privilege changes N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

04. Password aging, quality, and PAM

- [ ] **D045** Inspect login.defs password-aging defaults N/A

- [ ] **D046** Inspect each authorized user's actual aging with chage -l N/A
- [ ] **D047** Check password-required/empty-password status when applicable N/A
- [ ] **D048** Inspect common-auth PAM lines N/A
- [ ] **D049** Inspect common-password PAM lines N/A
- [ ] **D050** Check which PAM modules and auth profiles are actually installed N/A
- [ ] **D051** Inspect pam_pwquality usage and settings N/A
- [ ] **D052** Inspect password history integration if required N/A
- [ ] **D053** Inspect failed-login/lockout module integration if required N/A
- [ ] **D054** Check for unexpected pam_exec or pam_permit entries N/A
- [ ] **D055** Check packaged PAM file integrity with dpkg -V when appropriate N/A
- [ ] **D056** Preserve original common-auth before changes N/A
- [ ] **D057** Preserve original common-password before changes N/A
- [ ] **D058** Set user password aging only to README-required values N/A
- [ ] **D059** Set an authorized user's password interactively if required N/A
- [ ] **D060** Validate PAM integration before ending the current root session N/A
- [ ] **D061** Test a new authorized normal-user login N/A
- [ ] **D062** Test sudo elevation in a second session N/A
- [ ] **D063** Verify final chage and PAM settings against the requirement N/A
- [ ] **D064** Restore the exact PAM backup if authentication fails N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

05. Signed APT sources, packages and updates

- [ ] **D065** Record the installed Debian release codename N/A
- [ ] **D066** Inspect active .list and deb822 .sources entries N/A
- [ ] **D067** Check configured Debian security suite for the installed release N/A
- [ ] **D068** Check apt repository signatures and any Trusted=yes bypass N/A
- [ ] **D069** Check for mixed Ubuntu/Mint/testing/unstable sources N/A
- [ ] **D070** Identify unknown repositories and their owner/purpose N/A
- [ ] **D071** Inspect held packages using apt-mark showhold N/A
- [ ] **D072** Check incomplete packages with dpkg --audit N/A
- [ ] **D073** Run apt update and investigate errors N/A
- [ ] **D074** Preview upgrades before applying them N/A

- [ ] **D075** Check if approved security updates are outstanding N/A
- [ ] **D076** Check unattended-upgrades package if the image requires it N/A
- [ ] **D077** Inspect automatic update timer and periodic configuration N/A
- [ ] **D078** Inspect supported Debian LTS coverage for relevant packages N/A
- [ ] **D079** Apply approved updates without performing a release upgrade N/A
- [ ] **D080** Recheck package state and required application functionality N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

06. Firewall and exposed network services

- [ ] **D081** Inventory listening TCP services with ss N/A
- [ ] **D082** Inventory listening UDP services with ss N/A
- [ ] **D083** Inspect native nftables ruleset N/A
- [ ] **D084** Check whether nftables.service controls the firewall N/A
- [ ] **D085** Check whether UFW is installed and active N/A
- [ ] **D086** Identify any other firewall manager already in use N/A
- [ ] **D087** List README-required inbound service ports N/A
- [ ] **D088** Identify required management source addresses N/A
- [ ] **D089** Back up the actual firewall configuration before edits N/A
- [ ] **D090** Validate nftables config syntax when applicable N/A
- [ ] **D091** Ensure required SSH access remains possible before deny rules N/A
- [ ] **D092** Add only necessary service exceptions N/A
- [ ] **D093** Apply reviewed firewall policy only with recovery access N/A
- [ ] **D094** Verify effective rules after changes N/A
- [ ] **D095** Test required service connections from an authorized client N/A
- [ ] **D096** Restore the old specific rule/config if access breaks N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

07. SSH authentication, ports and authorized keys

- [ ] **D097** Check whether openssh-server is installed and required N/A
- [ ] **D098** Check ssh service status and startup state N/A
- [ ] **D099** Check ssh.socket status if used N/A

- [ ] **D100** Record actual SSH listening interface and port N/A
- [ ] **D101** Inspect sshd_config and included snippets N/A
- [ ] **D102** Check PermitRootLogin effective value N/A
- [ ] **D103** Check PermitEmptyPasswords effective value N/A
- [ ] **D104** Check PasswordAuthentication effective value N/A
- [ ] **D105** Check PubkeyAuthentication and authorized client need N/A
- [ ] **D106** Check Match blocks that change settings by user or host N/A
- [ ] **D107** Search authorized_keys files for unexpected entries N/A
- [ ] **D108** Check ownership and permissions of relevant SSH keys N/A
- [ ] **D109** Back up the specific config before a change N/A
- [ ] **D110** Validate config syntax with sshd -t N/A
- [ ] **D111** Reload only the applicable SSH service after approved edits N/A
- [ ] **D112** Test a second SSH login before closing the first N/A
- [ ] **D113** Verify final effective settings and port listener N/A
- [ ] **D114** Restore backup from VM console if SSH access breaks N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

08. Required and unnecessary services

- [ ] **D115** Inventory running systemd services N/A
- [ ] **D116** Inventory enabled service units N/A
- [ ] **D117** Inspect failed systemd units N/A
- [ ] **D118** Inspect active socket units and activation paths N/A
- [ ] **D119** Identify service dependencies and required client operations N/A
- [ ] **D120** Check Apache or Nginx if README-required N/A
- [ ] **D121** Check MariaDB/MySQL or PostgreSQL if README-required N/A
- [ ] **D122** Check Samba sharing if README-required N/A
- [ ] **D123** Check DNS or DHCP servers if README-required N/A
- [ ] **D124** Check FTP, mail or printing if README-required N/A
- [ ] **D125** Check listening ports against required services N/A
- [ ] **D126** Inspect unwanted legacy Telnet/TFTP/VNC services if installed N/A
- [ ] **D127** Inspect suspicious service ExecStart and User fields N/A
- [ ] **D128** Preserve configuration and evidence before service changes N/A

- [ ] **D129** Disable only confirmed unauthorized services N/A
- [ ] **D130** Verify every README-required role still performs its function N/A
- [ ] **D131** Restore the original startup/running state if needed N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

09. Software, games, media and installed applications

- [ ] **D132** Inventory installed packages for explicitly prohibited software N/A
- [ ] **D133** Inspect games installed as GNOME packages if present N/A
- [ ] **D134** Inspect unauthorized network, password-cracking or remote tools N/A
- [ ] **D135** Check Firefox ESR or other README-required browsers N/A
- [ ] **D136** Inspect portable executables outside APT package inventory N/A
- [ ] **D137** Check relevant files in home, tmp and var/tmp N/A
- [ ] **D138** Find potentially prohibited media files without mass deletion N/A
- [ ] **D139** Preserve user or forensic files associated with a question N/A
- [ ] **D140** Preview APT purge dependencies before removing a package N/A
- [ ] **D141** Remove only a confirmed prohibited package or file N/A
- [ ] **D142** Verify package state and required applications afterward N/A
- [ ] **D143** Restore a mistakenly removed app with its configuration N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

10. File ownership, permissions and capabilities

- [ ] **D144** Inspect /etc/passwd owner/group and file permissions N/A
- [ ] **D145** Inspect /etc/group owner/group and file permissions N/A
- [ ] **D146** Inspect /etc/shadow and /etc/gshadow access restrictions N/A
- [ ] **D147** Inspect /etc/sudoers and sudoers.d permissions N/A
- [ ] **D148** Search for world-writable files in /etc N/A
- [ ] **D149** Search for suspicious writable files in /usr/local or /opt N/A
- [ ] **D150** Inventory unusual SUID executables in relevant directories N/A
- [ ] **D151** Inventory unusual SGID executables in relevant directories N/A
- [ ] **D152** Check capability-bearing binaries if getcap is installed N/A
- [ ] **D153** Check home directory exposure for required users N/A

- [ ] **D154** Compare suspicious binary ownership with dpkg package records N/A
- [ ] **D155** Record original owner/mode before any adjustment N/A
- [ ] **D156** Fix only a verified incorrect sensitive-file permission N/A
- [ ] **D157** Verify needed programs and normal login still work N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

11. Scheduled tasks, startup and persistence

- [ ] **D158** Inspect root crontab N/A
- [ ] **D159** Inspect system crontab N/A
- [ ] **D160** Inspect scheduled entries in cron.d N/A
- [ ] **D161** Inspect user crontabs relevant to the question N/A
- [ ] **D162** Inspect enabled systemd units N/A
- [ ] **D163** Inspect systemd timers N/A
- [ ] **D164** Inspect suspicious unit file and ExecStart command N/A
- [ ] **D165** Check service logs and execution times N/A
- [ ] **D166** Inspect shell profile and profile.d startup entries N/A
- [ ] **D167** Inspect suspicious PATH modifications and aliases N/A
- [ ] **D168** Inspect /etc/hosts for unexpected redirects N/A
- [ ] **D169** Map unexpected network listeners to processes N/A
- [ ] **D170** Preserve task/unit configuration and forensic evidence N/A
- [ ] **D171** Disable only a confirmed malicious scheduled entry N/A
- [ ] **D172** Verify unwanted persistence no longer activates N/A
- [ ] **D173** Restore any required job or service mistakenly disabled N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

12. Logging, AppArmor and kernel security

- [ ] **D174** Inspect journald boot history and log retention N/A
- [ ] **D175** Check relevant authentication events N/A
- [ ] **D176** Check journal error and warning events N/A
- [ ] **D177** Check whether rsyslog is installed and required N/A
- [ ] **D178** Check whether auditd is installed and required N/A

- [ ] **D179** Check audit rules and disk/log volume before new rules N/A
- [ ] **D180** Check AppArmor service and module status N/A
- [ ] **D181** Inspect AppArmor enforcing/complain profiles N/A
- [ ] **D182** Investigate relevant AppArmor DENIED events N/A
- [ ] **D183** Check kernel ASLR setting N/A
- [ ] **D184** Check forwarding policy when the machine is not a router N/A
- [ ] **D185** Check redirects/source-routing settings if required N/A
- [ ] **D186** Check IPv6 role before changing IPv6 sysctl N/A
- [ ] **D187** Back up actual sysctl/profile files before changes N/A
- [ ] **D188** Verify required services after AppArmor/sysctl changes N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

13. Critical-server role checks (when required)

- [ ] **D189** Record required server roles before changing their configurations N/A
- [ ] **D190** Back up actual configuration for each required role N/A
- [ ] **D191** Check Apache site and directory browsing policy N/A
- [ ] **D192** Validate Apache syntax before reload N/A
- [ ] **D193** Test required Apache site from an authorized client N/A
- [ ] **D194** Check Nginx server_tokens and autoindex if installed N/A
- [ ] **D195** Validate Nginx syntax before reload N/A
- [ ] **D196** Test required Nginx site and hostname N/A
- [ ] **D197** Check PHP web SAPI settings if applicable N/A
- [ ] **D198** Check MariaDB authentication and database privileges if required N/A
- [ ] **D199** Test required database query/application operation N/A
- [ ] **D200** Check vsftpd anonymous access if FTP is required N/A
- [ ] **D201** Test authorized FTP login and data transfer N/A
- [ ] **D202** Check Samba share definitions and filesystem permissions N/A
- [ ] **D203** Validate Samba config with testparm if installed N/A
- [ ] **D204** Test authorized Samba client read/write N/A
- [ ] **D205** Check required DNS zone/records and query behavior N/A
- [ ] **D206** Check required DHCP pool and client leases N/A
- [ ] **D207** Check mail server authentication and relay restrictions if required N/A

- [ ] **D208** Restore only a changed service config if a client test fails N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

14. Desktop and final verification

- [ ] **D209** Identify current display manager and desktop environment N/A
- [ ] **D210** Check GNOME or actual desktop automatic login setting N/A
- [ ] **D211** Check screen lock after inactivity N/A
- [ ] **D212** Check lock on resume if the desktop provides it N/A
- [ ] **D213** Check unauthorized remote desktop or sharing N/A
- [ ] **D214** Check normal user login and sudo elevation N/A
- [ ] **D215** Reopen every forensic question and verify saved answers N/A
- [ ] **D216** Recheck users and privileged groups against README N/A
- [ ] **D217** Recheck firewall and required service clients N/A
- [ ] **D218** Recheck failed services and security logs N/A
- [ ] **D219** Recheck installed updates and held packages N/A
- [ ] **D220** Confirm unauthorized programs and persistence were addressed N/A
- [ ] **D221** Refresh scoring report and record final value N/A
- [ ] **D222** Record N/A items and reasons N/A
- [ ] **D223** Save rollback notes and finish without unsafe reboot N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

FINAL REVIEW - required services tested / exceptions / reviewer:

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